

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 846

By Reeves

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Kenneth Hollis Choate, Jr., of Thompson's Station.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Kenneth Hollis Choate, Jr., of Thompson's Station; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Choate was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Choate was born on January 26, 1945, in Houston, Texas; he graduated from Conroe High School and went on to serve his country with honor and courage as a captain in the United States Army, 21<sup>st</sup> Infantry Regiment, during the Vietnam War from 1966 to 1970; and

WHEREAS, he was awarded the Bronze Star Medal with one oak leaf cluster for his bravery, leadership, and exemplary service to his country; and

WHEREAS, following his military service, Kenneth Choate earned his degree in veterinary science from Texas A&M University, and he then began working alongside his family, owning the Conroe Ballroom and later establishing the Frontier Palace, gathering places that featured top country music artists and various special events; and

WHEREAS, he later moved to Hawaii, where he enjoyed a career as a home builder and developer alongside his wife, Donna; together, they helped design and build more than 2,200 homes, creating entire communities and touching countless families; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Choate served as a board member of the National Home Builders Association, president of the Building Industry Association of Hawaii, and a founding member of

the Building Industry Association Construction Training Center of the Pacific in Honolulu, Hawaii; and

WHEREAS, deeply devoted to his family, Mr. Choate enjoyed the loving companionship of his wife of fifty-seven years, Donna Melder Choate, and was the proud father of Kari (Don) Shepherd and Kelly (Michelle) Choate; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his wife and children, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his grandchildren, Keller Shepherd, McKenna Shepherd, Sawyer Shepherd, Elizabeth Shepherd, Ruby Rae Shepherd, Joshua (Jamie) Choate, Caleb Choate, David Choate, Jonathan Choate, and Joy Choate; great-grandchildren, Theodore Choate, Charlotte Choate, Georgiana Choate, and Raphael Choate; and a host of extended family and friends; and

WHEREAS, he was preceded in death by his parents, Nettie Jane Roberts Choate-Aldrich and Kenneth Hollis Choate, Sr.; sister, Dolores Jane Feagin; and brother, David Leslie Choate; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Choate was a faithful follower of Jesus, known for his gentle spirit, steady kindness, and selfless dedication to helping others; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Choate leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Kenneth Hollis Choate, Jr., reflecting fondly upon

his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Choate.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.